COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

POLISH, AUTOMOBILE, (LIQUID AND PASTE)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification P-P-546.

This commercial item description covers two types and two classes of polish suitable for cleaning and protecting automobile finishes.

The automobile polish shall be of the following types and classes:

Type I - Liquid
Type II - Paste

Class 1 - Without silicone
Class 2 - With silicone

Salient characteristics:

The polishes shall consist of natural or synthetic waxes, or a mixture of both, volatile aliphatic solvents, polishing oils or silicone oils as applicable and mild abrasives. The type I polish shall be emulsified in water to form a stable, free-flowing emulsion that can be readily dispersed upon shaking.

Gloss. The polish shall produce a gloss equal or superior to that produced by the comparison sample, (see note).

Preparation of test panels. Prepare five duplicate panels of the comparison sample and the test polish. Obtain steel panels covered with black automobile-lacquer [1/] and buff with 00 steel wool until a uniform matte finish is obtained. Wash with alcohol, rinse with tap water, and blot dry with a paper towel.

Application of polish. Using a soft cloth, apply a small amount of polish to the test panel, rubbing in a circular motion with the end of one finger. Use moderate pressure for a few seconds to apply a thin, even layer of polish. Allow the polished panel to dry for 5 to 6 minutes at room temperature and examine visually. Panel should be free from streaking and irregular deposits of polish. Buff lightly with lambs wool for 3 to 4 seconds and measure gloss.

Gloss measurement. Gloss measurement shall be conducted with an instrument conforming to ASTM D 523 using an angle of reflectance of 60 degrees.

Weatherability. The polish shall retain a gloss equal or superior to that of the comparison sample.

Weathering apparatus. Use a weathering apparatus for exposing polished panels to cycles of carbon arc light and water spray conforming to ASTM G-23. Alternately, the same exposure may be produced with the xenon-arc apparatus conforming to ASTM G-26.

Gloss retention after weathering. Prepare five duplicate panels of the comparison sample and the test polish and place in the weathering apparatus. Subject them to a cycle of 102 minutes of carbon arc light and 18 minutes of water spray for a 48-hour period. Remove the panels from the apparatus and wipe them lightly with a soft cloth. Let the panels dry and then determine the gloss of each panel within 24-hours as specified above under gloss measurement.

Cleaning ability. The polish shall completely remove the test soil from the panels when tested as follows:

Preparation of test panels. Prepare five white panels as described under gloss, except buffing to a matte finish is not required; apply drops of a 1 percent solution of standard soil 2/ in tap water over the surface of the panel and allow to dry at room temperature. Then allow to stand for 16 hours in an oven maintained at 105°C ± 2°C. The dried, baked soil should appear as a pattern of dirty spots on the test panels.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-24T02:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Application of polish. Apply polish as described under gloss. After buffing for 3 to 4 seconds with lambs wool, examine the panel visually for traces of unremoved soil.

1/ 4 x 6" panels are available from the Ford Motor Company, Central Lake Services, 3001 Miller Road, Dearborn, MI 48121.

2/ Standard soil is available as "WG-2000 RS" from Gardner Laboratory, Inc., 5521 Landy Lane, P.O. Box 5728, Bethesda, MD 20014.

The issues of ASTM test methods in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with stated requirements.

Certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product sold in the commercial marketplace. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Packaging, packing, and marking. The items shall be packaged in accordance with normal commercial practice and packed to assure acceptance by common carrier and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. The shipping container shall be in compliance with National Motor Freight Classification and Uniform Freight Classification. Shipping containers shall be marked as specified in the contract or order.

Note: The comparison sample, (Rally Cream Wax, Dupont, Wilmington, DE 19898), shall be used in the comparison of all types and classes.

The ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

MILITARY INTEREST:

NO INTEREST

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

CPS
GSA-FSS, PBO
VA-DMS

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-24T02:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

GSA DC-01104487